

Phase 1: Brainstorming & Ideation

Empathy Map: ComicCraft User Analysis

1. Overview

The Empathy Map is a collaborative visual tool used to articulate what we know about a particular type of user. It externalizes knowledge about users in order to create a shared understanding of user needs and aid in design decision-making.

2. User Empathy Matrix

SAYS		THINKS	
- "I have awesome story ideas, but I can't draw."		- "Is there a tool that can turn my plot into a graphic novel?"	
- "Commissions take weeks and are very expensive."		- "I wish I could control the art style and mood."	
- "Can I export this so I can print and read it?"		- "Will the characters look consistent across all the comic panels?"	
DOES		FEELS	
- Writes narrative drafts in notepad apps.		- Excited when imagining story scenarios.	
- Tries basic text-to-image prompts but struggles to connect multiple images into a story arc.		- Intimidated by complex graphic design suites.	
- Searches for easy storyboard templates online.		- Frustrated by lack of drawing skills.	
- Shares creative story outputs on social media.		- Delighted when reading an engaging story strip.	
		- Proud when holding a tangible PDF comic.	

3. Pains & Gains Analysis

Pains (Frictions & Roadblocks):

1. Artistic Impasse: Inability to sketch, color, and ink visually appealing comic panels.
2. Disconnected Generative Tools: Existing AI tools generate one image or one block of text, forcing users to manually stitch them together.
3. Complex Layout Software: Assembling titles, dialog boxes, narration, and captions requires high technical proficiency.
4. Time & Cost: Traditional comic illustration requires days to weeks per page.

Gains (Aspirations & Desired Outcomes):

1. Instant Gratification: Transforming a 2-sentence prompt into a complete 5-panel comic strip in seconds.
2. Creative Control: Fine-tuning character names, settings, tones (funny, dramatic, poetic), and art styles (anime, comic book, realistic).
3. Publication-Ready Deliverable: Downloading a timestamped, professionally structured PDF document with zero formatting hassle.
4. Frictionless Iteration: Easily regenerating new variants with tweaked styles until the creative vision is perfected.